

USER MANUAL · ENGLISH EDITION

The Investor's Ledger

*A private, AI-powered investment journal
for thoughtful long-term investors*

Part 0 • The Premise

Most investment mistakes are not made in ignorance. They are made in the fog of the moment — when you knew your rule and broke it anyway, when you told yourself a story that felt true at the time, when fear dressed itself up as analysis. Six months later, you can no longer remember exactly what you were thinking. The outcome has colonised the memory.

The most expensive thing in investing is not a bad trade. It is the inability to learn from one.

Learning requires a record. Not a record of outcomes — those you already have, in your brokerage account. A record of *thinking*: what you were reasoning when you acted, what you were feeling, which rules you verified, what you feared, what you hoped. These are the inputs that determined the decision. They are also the only inputs that can be changed.

This app exists to capture that record systematically — at the moment of decision, before outcome has a chance to rewrite the story.

Part 1 · The Second Brain

A journal is only as useful as its structure allows.

Notes scattered across a generic app are hard to query, impossible to compare across time, and invisible to AI.

The Investor's Ledger stores every trade, every thought, every review as *structured data*: typed fields, consistent schema, timestamped entries, emotion and reasoning captured alongside the decision. This structure is not bureaucracy. It is what makes your notes queryable — by search, by pattern, and by intelligence.

The **Obsidian Vault export** is the most significant feature in the app. When you export your Vault, the app converts your entire journal into structured Markdown files with YAML front-matter — individual files per trade, per thought, per weekly note, per monthly review, with bidirectional links between them. This is the format that knowledge-base tools and AI agents understand natively. Once exported, your journal lives outside any single application, in a format you own and control indefinitely.

This is the foundation of a **second brain** for your investment thinking. A permanent, portable, AI-readable record of how your mind has worked — and how it has grown. The app is not the destination. The structured data it produces is.

Import the Vault zip into **Obsidian** and your entire journal becomes a searchable knowledge graph. Load it as context into any AI agent — Claude, GPT, local models — and you have a system that can reason over years of your actual thinking, not just generic investment knowledge.

Part 2 · The AI Layer

Most AI tools answer from general knowledge. The mentors in this app answer from yours.

When you ask Warren Buffett's persona about a position, it has read your specific trades, your stated philosophy, your emotional patterns, your weekly reflections, your rule violations. It is not delivering a lecture on moats. It is applying Buffett's framework to *your actual behaviour* — the gap between what you said you would do and what you actually did.

This is only possible because of the structured recording. The AI is not inferring your patterns from a few sentences. It is reading your second brain.

THE SEVEN MENTORS

MENTOR	FRAMEWORK
你的导师 · Your Mentor	Personalised to your journal, trades, and patterns
彼得·林奇 · Peter Lynch	Invest in what you know; GARP; simple businesses
巴菲特 · Warren Buffett	Wonderful companies at fair prices; moats; long-term
芒格 · Charlie Munger	Mental models; inversion; incentives; blunt
达利欧 · Ray Dalio	Principles; cycles; diversification; stress-testing
霍华德·马克斯 · Howard Marks	Second-level thinking; cycle awareness; risk vs. return
格雷厄姆 · Benjamin Graham	Margin of safety; intrinsic value; quantitative discipline

The Obsidian export extends the AI layer further. Every agent you use in the future can be given your journal as a knowledge base. You are not just keeping a record. You are **building an asset**.

Part 3 · The Recording Habit

The value of this system is proportional to the quality of what you put into it. One honest entry recorded before a trade is worth more than ten reconstructed after the fact.

TRADE RECORDS (记录 · 交易计划)

Navigate to the **Log** tab and tap **新建交易** (New Trade). Two input modes:

AI Smart Input — write or dictate a freeform description. The AI extracts structured fields automatically. Use this when you need to act quickly and still want a complete record.

Manual Input — fill each field directly:

FIELD	WHY IT MATTERS
ACTION	Buy / Sell / Hold / Watch
STOCK	Searchable by ticker or name (AAPL, 腾讯, BTC)
DATE	Defaults to today; future dates can trigger a calendar reminder
REASON	The thesis, written <i>before</i> you act. The most important field in the app.
EMOTION	Calm / Confident / Neutral / Anxious / Fearful — at the moment of decision
RULES CHECK	Which of your personal rules you verified before acting

After a Buy or Sell, the app prompts you to update Holdings. Tap **确认更新持仓** or **跳过** to skip.

The REASON field asks a specific question: *What would have to be true for this to be a good decision?* Answer it in writing before you act. Your future self will hold your present self accountable to it.

THOUGHT RECORDS (心念)

Switch to the **心念** sub-tab for everything that does not yet qualify as a trade decision — the doubts, the half-formed intuitions, the positions you almost took. Tap **记下心念** and write freely. *Indecision is data too.*

Both trades and thoughts support **mentor feedback**: expand any entry and tap **求教 [Mentor]** for a streamed response. Tap **继续 ↗** to carry that conversation into the full Mentor chat with context pre-loaded.

Part 4 · Portfolio and Context

The Holdings tab (持仓) is not primarily a portfolio tracker — though it functions as one. Its deeper purpose is to give the AI mentor *current, grounded context* when you ask about your portfolio.

Tap 新增持仓. Beyond the basics, the fields that matter most for AI context:

- **REASON TO BUY** — your original thesis. When you ask a mentor about a position later, it will measure your current thinking against this.
- **NOTES** — stop levels, monitoring triggers, conditions that would change your view.
- **BUY DATE** — gives the mentor a timeline for the position.

The 带入问道 ↗ link on any holding opens the Mentor tab with a pre-composed message containing your full position details. The mentor already has context before you type a word.

Tap 刷新 to fetch live prices from Yahoo Finance. Prices auto-sync when the Mentor tab opens. The **TOTALS · 汇总** section aggregates cost, market value, and P&L by currency.

Part 5 · The Review Loop

Navigate to **Review** (复盘). Two sub-screens:

周记 · Weekly Notes — a brief weekly reflection on what happened, how you responded, what you noticed about your own behaviour. Regularity matters more than length. A few sentences each week compounds into a complete cognitive history over a year.

月评 · Monthly Review — a deeper review of decision quality for the month. Not returns — process. Were outcomes consistent with the quality of the reasoning? Where did process and result diverge? A banner on the Home screen appears at month-end if you have unreviewed trades.

Review entries are included when the AI mentors read your journal. An investor who reviews consistently gives their mentor exponentially richer material.

Part 6 · The Mentor

Navigate to **Mentor** (问道). The header shows how much of your journal has been loaded: trades, holdings, weekly notes, monthly reviews. This is the scope of what the mentor has read.

Select a mentor from the chip row. Each maintains a **separate, independent conversation thread**. Tap **RESET** to clear the current master's thread; others are unaffected.

Type your question and tap send. If the AI is unreachable, tap **重新发送** (Retry) — no need to retype. **Long-press** any message to copy it.

Suggested opening questions:

- "帮我看看最近几笔交易有什么规律?" — Help me find patterns in my recent trades
- "我焦虑的时候做的决定, 结果通常怎样?" — What happens when I decide under anxiety?
- "我的哪条规则最容易被我自己违反?" — Which rule do I break most often?
- "下个月我应该重点关注什么?" — What should I focus on next month?

Part 7 · Setup and Settings

Access Settings via the **gear icon (⚙️)** on the Home screen.

DEEPSEEK API KEY

1. Visit **platform.deepseek.com**, create an account, and generate a key starting with `sk-`
2. Paste it into the **DeepSeek API Key** field and tap **保存 API Key**
3. Status changes from red **未配置** to green **已配置**

Typical monthly cost: \$1–3 USD, with server-side prefix caching reducing repeated costs automatically.

HOME SCREEN — PHILOSOPHY AND RULES

The **Investment Philosophy** is your one-sentence investing principle — sent to every mentor as foundational context. Be specific. **Rules** are your verifiable pre-trade commitments (max 5). A rule must be falsifiable: "No single position over 25%" is a rule; "only buy quality" is not. The **Strategy Profile Report** (5+ trades required) generates an AI analysis of your actual behaviour. Tap **导出 PDF** to share it.

DATA EXPORT

Obsidian Vault (Recommended): Tap **导出 Vault** to generate a structured zip of all your data as Markdown files with YAML front-matter. This is your second brain in portable form.

JSON Backup: Full raw database export for device migration or backup.

PRIVACY

All journal data is stored in local SQLite on your device — nothing is uploaded to any server. DeepSeek receives only the relevant excerpts when you ask a mentor. Yahoo Finance receives only your ticker symbols.

Part 8 · The Discipline

A second brain is not built in a session. It is built in minutes, every day, over years.

1. **Record before you act, not after.** The reason field written before a trade is immune to outcome bias. Post-trade reconstruction is not.
2. **Log the moments of doubt, not just the decisions.** The trades you almost made are often more revealing than the ones you did.
3. **Be honest about emotion.** Logging "Fearful" when you were fearful is the only way to learn what fear-driven decisions actually produce.
4. **Use Your Mentor for patterns; use specific masters for frameworks.** One is a mirror; the other is a lens.
5. **Review every week, even briefly.** Continuity is the compounding mechanism. Fifty-two brief weekly notes outperform five long ones.
6. **Export to Obsidian regularly.** Your journal is an asset. Treat it like one — preserve it outside any single application, and make it available to every AI tool you will ever use.